Trump Says Russia and Ukraine Will Stop Attacking Power Plants

From: PBS NewsHour Mined: 2026-10-12 3 min read

On Sunday, U.S. **President** Donald Trump said Russia and Ukraine had agreed to an "**energy ceasefire**." A **ceasefire** is a deal to stop attacking. This one means not attacking power plants and other **energy sites**. Russia and Ukraine have been at war for about four and a half years.

Trump's short post online said the **ceasefire** started right away. He did not give other details. Russia did not comment right away.

Ukraine's **president**, Volodymyr Zelenskyy, said the news was "good news for everyone." But he said Russia was still attacking **energy sites** in Kyiv and Kharkiv. He said Ukraine was ready to stop too, if Russia did the same.

This has happened before. On September 14, Trump said the two countries agreed not to hit **energy sites**, but nothing changed.

Trump and Zelenskyy have also disagreed. Trump said Ukraine should get a new **president**. Zelenskyy said Ukraine's people should choose their own leader.

Word Treasure

ceasefire -- A deal to stop fighting or attacking.
energy -- Power like electricity that keeps lights and heat on.
president -- The leader of a country.
sites -- Places where something is built or happens.

Background you need

Russia and Ukraine are two neighboring countries that have been at war.

Power plants make electricity for homes, schools and hospitals.

When leaders agree to a ceasefire, both sides must follow it for it to work.

Break it down

WHO: U.S. President Donald Trump, Ukraine's President Volodymyr Zelenskyy and Russia
WHAT: Trump said the two countries agreed to stop attacking each other's energy sites
WHERE: Russia and Ukraine, including Kyiv and Kharkiv
WHY: Attacks on power plants hurt people, and leaders want them to stop

Why it matters

Power plants keep lights, heat and water working for families, so protecting them helps keep people safe.

Test what you remember

1. Who announced the energy ceasefire?

- (A) Donald Trump
- (B) Volodymyr Zelenskyy
- (C) The people of Kyiv
- (D) Russia's army

2. What is a ceasefire?

- (A) A deal to stop attacking
- (B) A type of power plant
- (C) A big party
- (D) A new election

3. What would this ceasefire protect?

- (A) Schools only
- (B) Power plants and other energy sites
- (C) Airports only
- (D) Farms

4. What did Zelenskyy say Russia was still doing?

- (A) Holding elections
- (B) Building schools
- (C) Attacking energy sites in Kyiv and Kharkiv
- (D) Sending gifts

5. When did Trump make a similar announcement before?

- (A) January 1
- (B) September 14
- (C) Never
- (D) July 4

6. Who should choose Ukraine's leader, according to Zelenskyy?

- (A) Russia
- (B) Ukraine's people
- (C) The United States
- (D) A computer

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: A 3: B 4: C 5: B 6: B

Questions to think about

1. President Donald Trump: Says Russia and Ukraine agreed to an energy ceasefire.
2. President Volodymyr Zelenskyy: Calls it good news but says Russia kept attacking, and Ukraine will stop if Russia does.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):